

Data notes: source, cleaning, checks and dictionary

How the raw file became the Data sheet, what was verified, and what each column means.

A. Source and provenance

Source file	SuperStore_Sales_Dataset.csv
Where it came from	
Raw size	5,901 rows and 23 columns before cleaning.

B. Cleaning log

Issue found	Action taken	Rows affected
First column header was corrupted ("Row ID+O6G3A1:R6").	Renamed to Row ID.	1 header
Two columns (ind1, ind2) were completely empty.	Removed.	2 columns x 5,901 rows
Order Date and Ship Date were text in DD-MM-YYYY format.	Converted to true Excel dates.	5,901 rows each
Returns column held N/A placeholders in 5,614 rows and the value 1 in 287 rows.	Replaced with a Returned column showing Yes or No.	5,901 rows
Leading or trailing spaces in text columns.	Checked every text column. None found.	0 rows
Exact duplicate rows.	Checked. None found.	0 rows
Ship Date earlier than Order Date.	Checked. None found (see live check below).	0 rows
Row ID 4918 appears on two unrelated orders.	Left unchanged and flagged. Row ID is not used as a key anywhere.	2 rows
28 Product IDs carry more than one Product Name.	Left unchanged. Product rankings use Product ID and show the first name found.	28 products
Return flags exist only for second-year orders.	Documented. Return analysis uses the second year only.	First year has 0 flags
Some lines show more profit than sales, which is unusual.	Kept and flagged. The effect on margins is shown in Product_Analysis section 7.	14 rows
The same Product ID is sold at very different unit prices (Sales divided by Quantity).	Left unchanged. The file has no discount column, so the cause cannot be confirmed.	Many products
Helper columns needed for analysis.	Added as formulas: Order Year, Quarter, Month Start, Ship Days, Order Flag, Order-Category Flag.	5,901 rows

C. Validation checks (live formulas)

Check	What it proves	Result	Expected	Status
Order lines loaded	The Data sheet holds every row from the source file.	5,901	5,901	PASS
Distinct orders	The Order Flag column counts each Order ID once.	3,003	n/a	PASS
Ship date before order date	No order ships before it was placed.	0	0	PASS
Blank cells in key columns	Order ID, dates, Region, Category, Sales and Profit are all filled.	0	0	PASS
Rows outside the two comparison years	The year lists on the Dashboard cover every row.	0	0	PASS
Sales difference: Data vs category table	The category table is complete.	-\$0.00	0	PASS
Sales difference: Data vs region table	The region table is complete.	-\$0.00	0	PASS
Sales difference: Data vs state scorecard	Every state is listed.	-\$0.00	0	PASS
Sales difference: Data vs product list	Every Product ID is listed in calc_Products.	-\$0.00	0	PASS
Sales difference: Data vs customer list	Every Customer ID is listed in calc_Customers.	-\$0.00	0	PASS
Return flags in the first year	Confirms the source has no return flags for the first year.	0	0	PASS
Lines where profit is higher than sales	Profit above sales is unusual. Flagged for review, not removed.	14	0	REVIEW

Expected values in blue are hardcoded from the source file (5,901 rows). The other expected values are zero by design.

D. Data dictionary (Data sheet)

Column	Description	Type	Origin
Row ID	Row number carried over from the source. Not unique (see cleaning log).	Number	Source
Order ID	Order reference. One order can hold several lines.	Text	Source
Order Date / Ship Date	Date the order was placed and shipped.	Date	Cleaned
Ship Mode	Same Day, First Class, Second Class or Standard Class.	Text	Source
Customer ID / Customer Name	Customer key and name.	Text	Source
Segment	Consumer, Corporate or Home Office.	Text	Source
Country / City / State / Region	Ship-to location. Region is Central, East, South or West.	Text	Source
Product ID / Product Name	Product key and description.	Text	Source
Category / Sub-Category	Product hierarchy: 3 categories, 17 sub-categories.	Text	Source
Sales	Line sales value. Currency is not stated and is assumed to be USD.	Currency	Source
Quantity	Units on the line.	Number	Source
Profit	Line profit. Negative means the line lost money.	Currency	Source
Returned	Yes if the line was flagged as returned, otherwise No.	Text	Cleaned
Payment Mode	Online, Cards or COD.	Text	Source

Order Year	Year of the order date.	Number	Formula
Quarter	Q1 to Q4 of the order date.	Text	Formula
Month Start	First day of the order month, used for the trend.	Date	Formula
Ship Days	Ship Date minus Order Date.	Number	Formula
Order Flag	1 on the first line of each Order ID, else 0. Sums to distinct orders.	Number	Formula
Order-Category Flag	1 on the first line of each Order ID and Category pair. Used when a Category filter is on.	Number	Formula